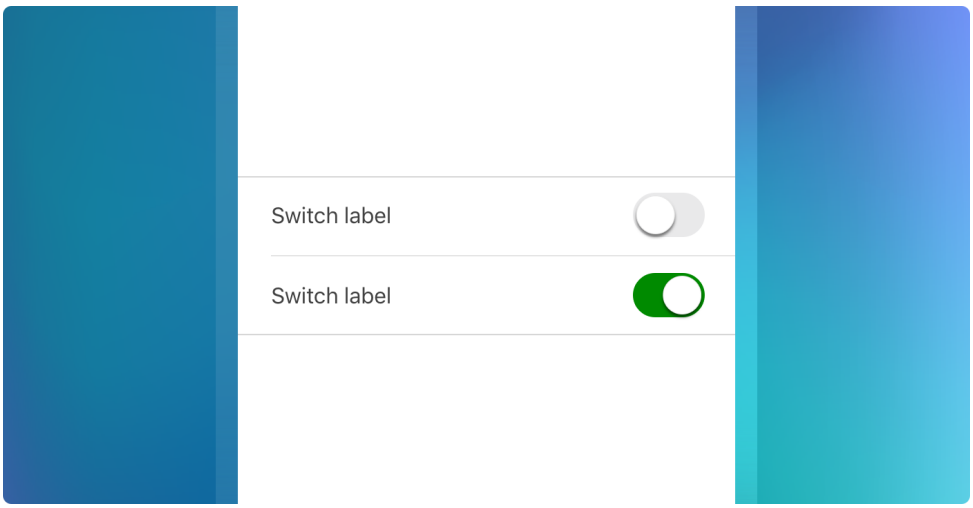
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Switch Row

Created by Tony Wang, last modified on 21 Jan 2021



Version

1

Availability

Android

iOS

On This Page

- Usage Guidelines
- Usage Examples
- Anatomy
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- Best Practices
- Content Guidelines
- Accessibility Considerations
- Supported States
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Switch Row represents a status of a particular setting, and it also allows users to toggle between On and Off states.

Useful Docs

- Switch Colour in iOS
- Don't use Switch in Web

Specs

- Switch Row (Android)
- Switch Row (iOS)

UI Playground

- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Usage Guidelines

Use Switch Row:

- When there are only 2 binary states of a setting (e.g. On and Off).
- To turn a feature on/off immediately (see Feature Switches).
- To store user preferences within a flow (See Preference Switches).

Don't use Switch Row:

- In Web platform, including mobile responsive. (See why we don't support Switch in Web)
- If 2 options are not binary. For example: Map View vs. List View. Use UI like Segmented control on iOS instead.

Usage Examples

A Switch Row represents the status of a specific feature, function or setting.

In this section, we highlight 2 main use cases for Switch Rows to guide you use this pattern correctly.

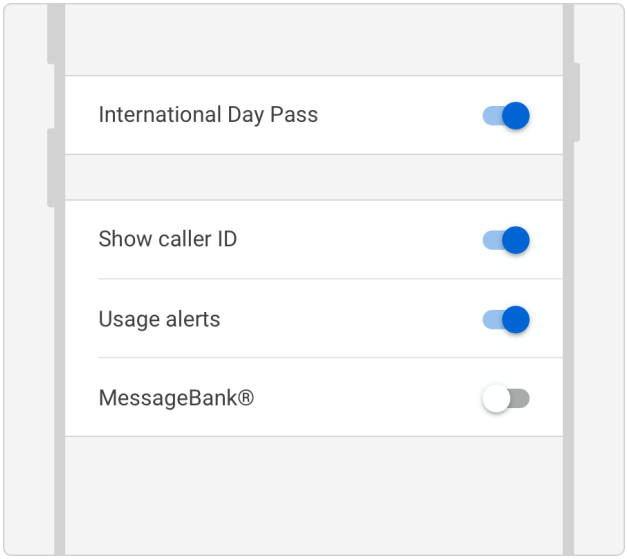
1. Feature Switches — Use it to turn a feature ON/OFF immediately.
2. Preference Switches — Use it to store user preferences within a flow.

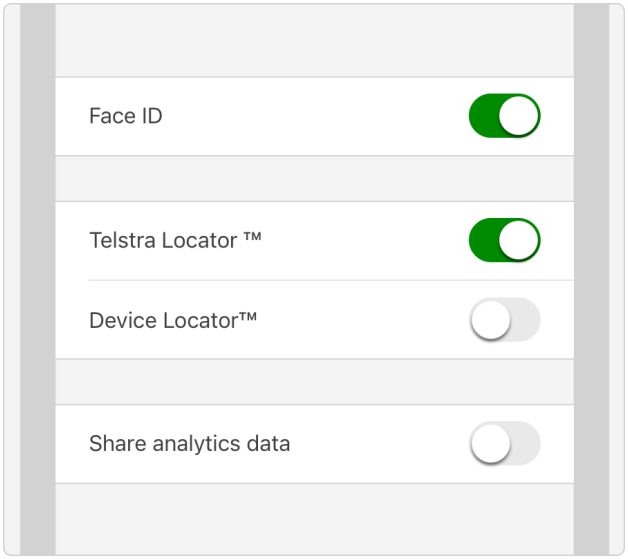
Use Case #1: Feature Switches

This is the most common use case of Switch Rows. The design of Switch UI originated from the light switches in the real-world. When you turn on a light switch, the room **immediately** lights up and remains lit until the switch is turned off.

In mobile design, the same concept applies. When a feature switch is ON it means the feature is enabled (or activated) **immediately**; OFF means disabled **immediately**.

Examples of Feature Switch:



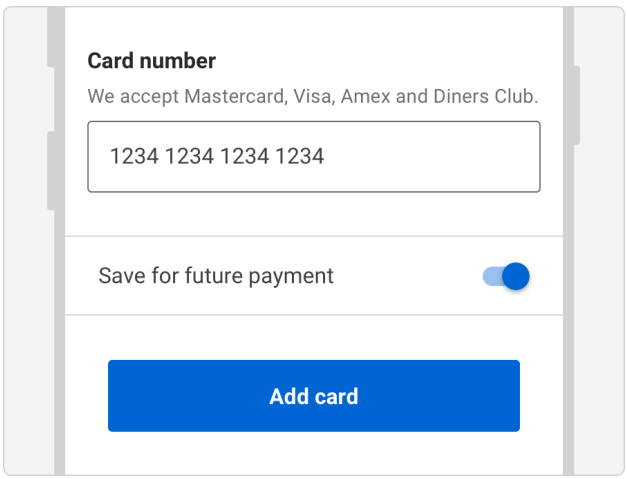


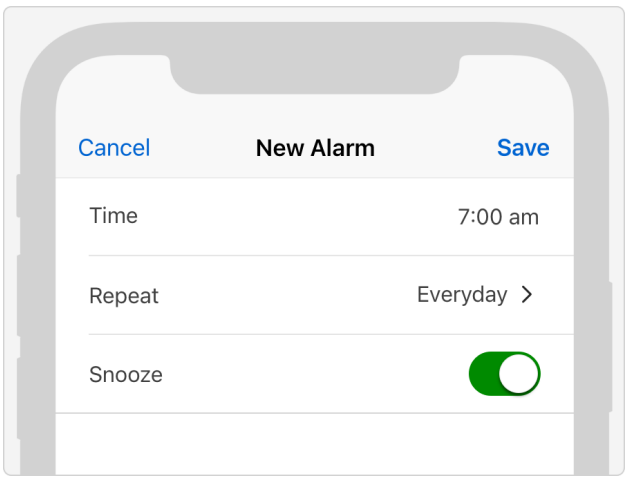
Use Case #2: Preferences Switches

Switch Rows can also be used to **remember a setting** or **to store user's preference**, especially when a user is in the middle of performing a task (e.g. creating a new calendar event, or adding a new credit card).

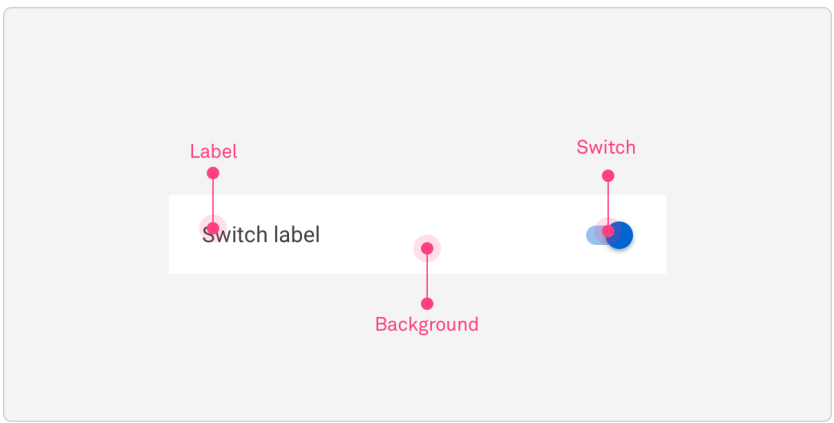
The value of the switch **does not take effect until a user completes their current tasks** (typically by pressing a CTA such as "Save", "Done", "Submit"). If the user cancels the task the preference is then discarded.

Examples of Preferences Switch:





Anatomy

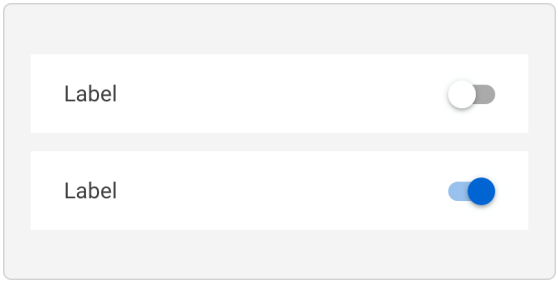


Design of Switch Rows

The appearance and interactions of Switch Rows in Android and iOS are **not identical**.

In order to provide intuitive user interfaces (familiarity & consistency), we've designed the Switch Row to follow platform's design guidelines (Material Design & Apple's HIG).

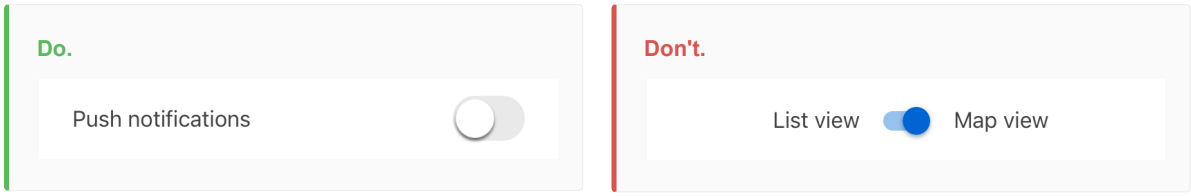
Android UI



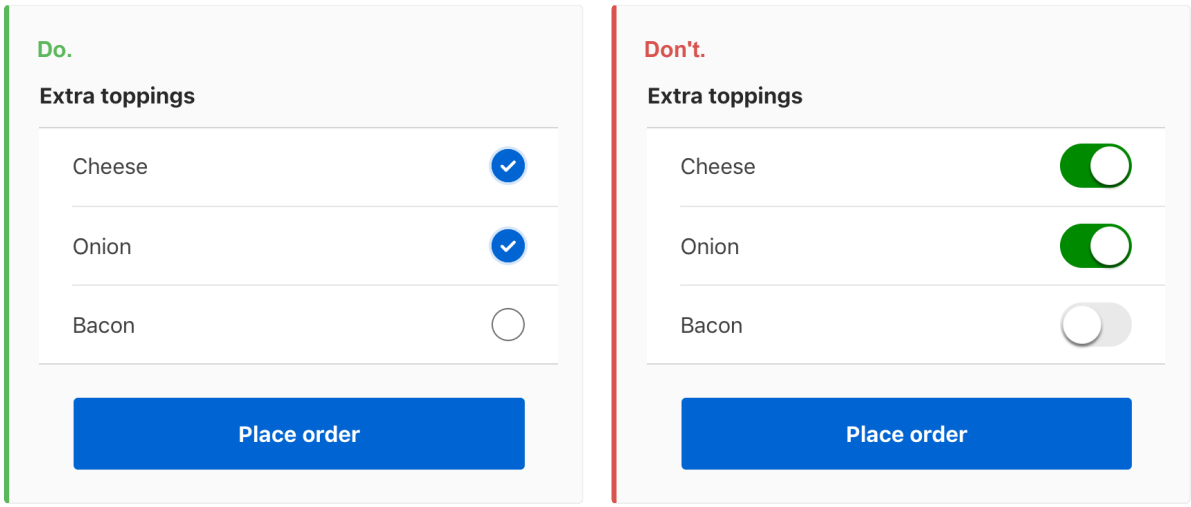
iOS UI

Best Practices

- **Use a switch when a setting has only 2 binary states to toggle between, usually 'On' or 'Off'.**
  Don't use switch when there are 2 opposing options to choose from. E.g. 'List View' vs. 'Map View' are separate and related, but neither action represents an 'On' or 'Off' state.

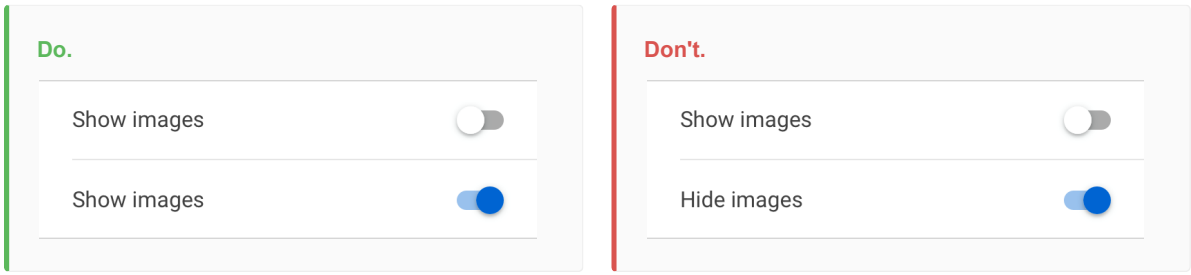


- **Don't use Switch Rows to perform multi-selection action.**
  Multi-selection **don't take effect immediately**. There's a Multi Select Row designed specifically for selection actions.

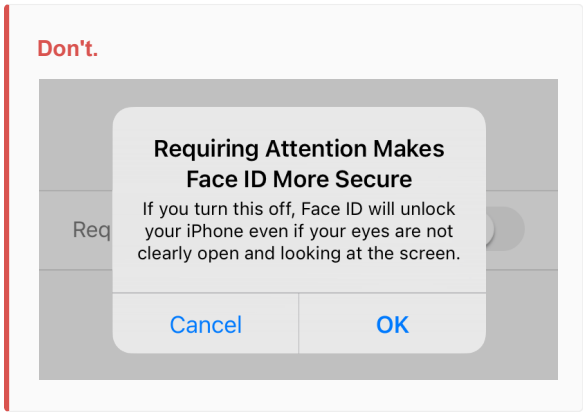


- **Always have an accompanying label that describes the setting.**
  Never use a Switch Row without a label or a standalone switch. It should always be displayed in a list format.

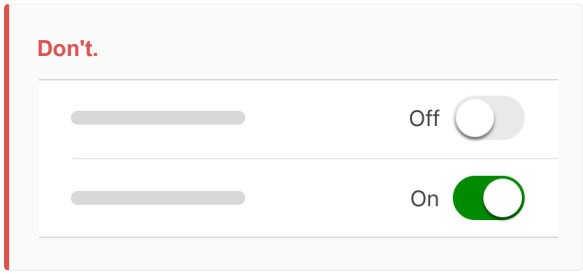
- **Switch label should not change regardless of whether the switch is on or off.**
  Changing the label when the state changes will confuse the user as to the actual current state of the switch.



- **Don't surface any UI after user interacting with the switch.**
  Avoid presenting any dialogues or sheets after user interacting with the switch. This interrupts the visual feedback of the switch status.



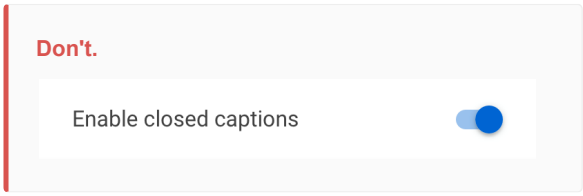
- **Don't add extra labels that describe the 'On' and 'Off' value of a switch.**
  Users may be confused as to whether the additional label describes the current state of the switch, or whether it's referring to the switch state when toggled to the side of the additional label.



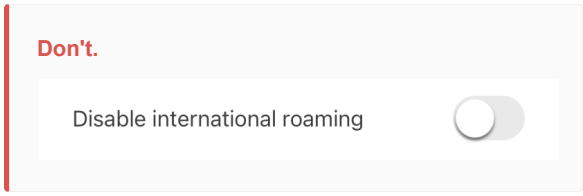
Content Guidelines

Switch Label

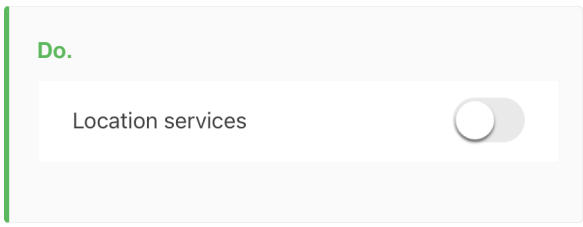
- Write switch label to describe the name of the setting. Avoid using verbs that describe change of state (e.g. 'Enable', 'Disable', 'Turn On', 'Turn Off')
  - Verbs are acceptable only if they are a part of the settings' name (e.g. 'Find my phone')

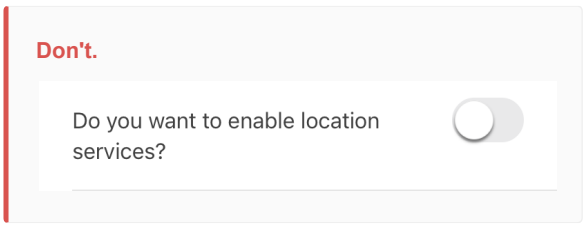


- Never write negative labels which require users to turn the switch on in order to turn the setting off.

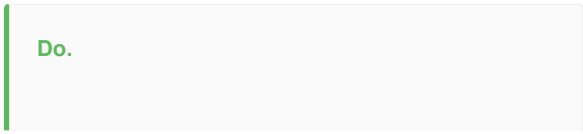


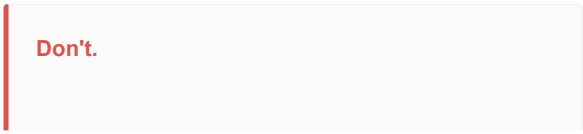
- Never phrase a switch label as a question.

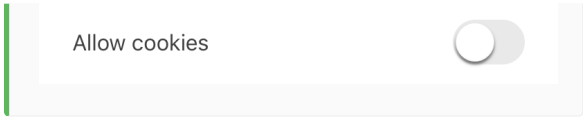


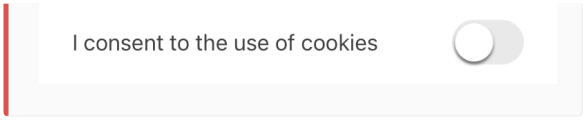


- Keep label succinct, ideally no longer than 3 words. Avoid being unnecessarily verbose.

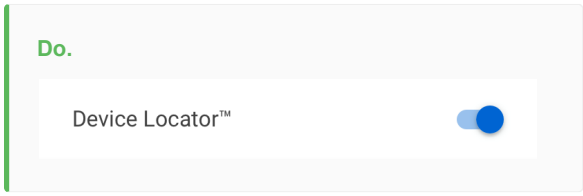








- Use sentence case, unless the setting or feature is a brand or product name.



For more guidelines please refer to Telstra's Content Style Guide.

Accessibility Considerations

Switch Row is designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern. Requirements marked with ⚠️ indicate partial compliance which must be met in build or authoring.

- 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A) - Each Switch Row must contain a label
- 1.4.3 Contrast Minimum (AA) - All text meets the 4.5:1 contrast ratio
- 1.4.4 Resize Text (AA) - When resized to largest settings on the device, text is not truncated
- 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA) - Aspects of the Switch Row required for identification meet the contrast ratio of 3:1 (See decision log for more detail on this requirement)
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Switch Row is keyboard accessible
- 2.4.3 Focus Order (A) - Switch Row are present in the focus order and follow a sequential focus order
- 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (AA) Labels are descriptive ⚠️
- 2.5.3 Label in Name (A) - The accessible name of the Switch Row matches the visible label
- 2.5.5 Target Size (AAA) - The touch target size is at least 48 x 48 (dp/pt/px)
- 3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (A) - Labels and instructional text are clear and unambiguous ⚠️
- 3.4.2 Consistent Identification (AA) - Switch Rows that capture the same data also contain the same label ⚠️
- 4.1.1 Parsing (A) - Switch Row uses valid code
- 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) - Switch Row is coded to expose the correct name, role and status to assistive technology

> **Note:**
> Currently the Able switch does not meet the requirement of having a visible keyboard focus state of >= 3:1 contrast ratio as defined in both 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA) and 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA). This is an update that will need to be carried out through all interactive rows on iOS and Android similar to the switch, and is in Able's backlog to be investigated.

Keyboard

- Users must be able to navigate to and interact with a Switch Row using an external keyboard.

Screen reader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/screen reader combination being used.

On screen reader focus, announcements must include:

- The **label**
- The **state** of the Switch Row eg. On or Off
- The **role** ie "switch button" or "switch"

When toggling from on/off or vice versa:

- The updated **state** of the Switch Row

Supported States

There are 2 supported states in Switch:

1. Off state (Left)
2. On state (Right)

For each state, there are the different interaction states:

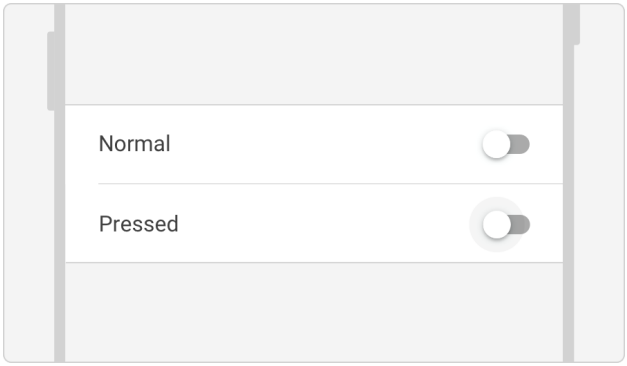
1. Normal
2. Pressed (Android only)

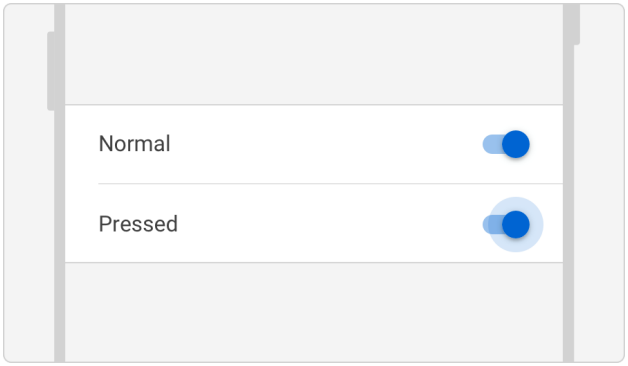
Keep in mind:

- '*Disabled state*' is not supported in Switch. See why we don't support disabled state.
- There is no '*Error state*'.
- *'Loading state'* is not yet supported. May be supported in the future up on request.

Android

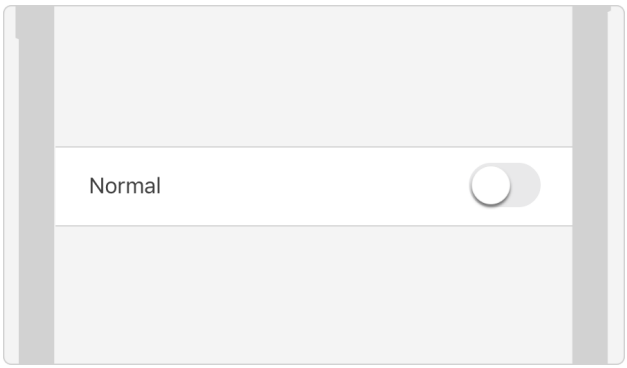
Row Off **Row On**



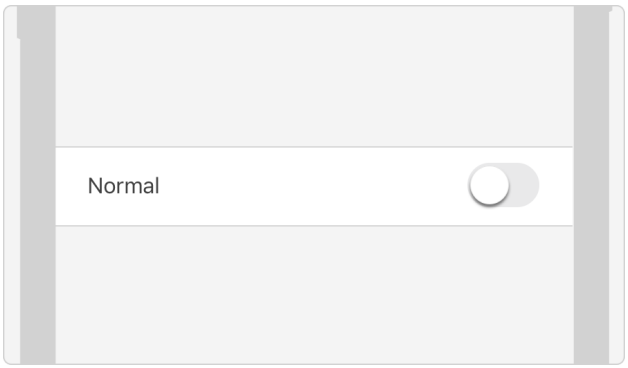


iOS

Row Off



Row On

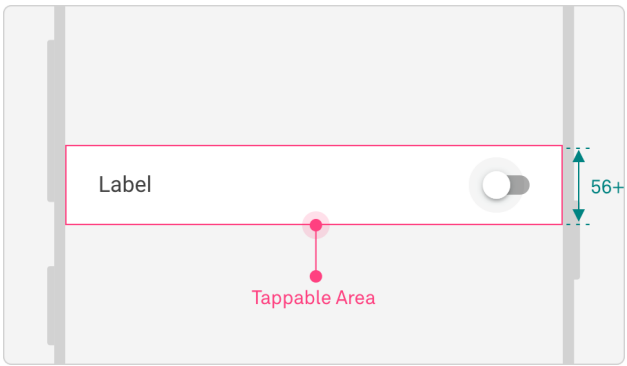


Find out more details on the different states, see Interaction States.

Tappable Area

The tappable area varies between Android and iOS in accordance with their native behaviours.

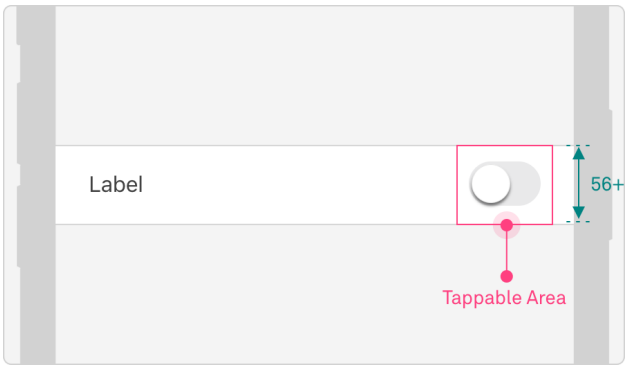
Android



Can be toggled by:

- Tapping or swiping on the switch control
- Tapping **anywhere** on the switch row

iOS



Can be toggled by:

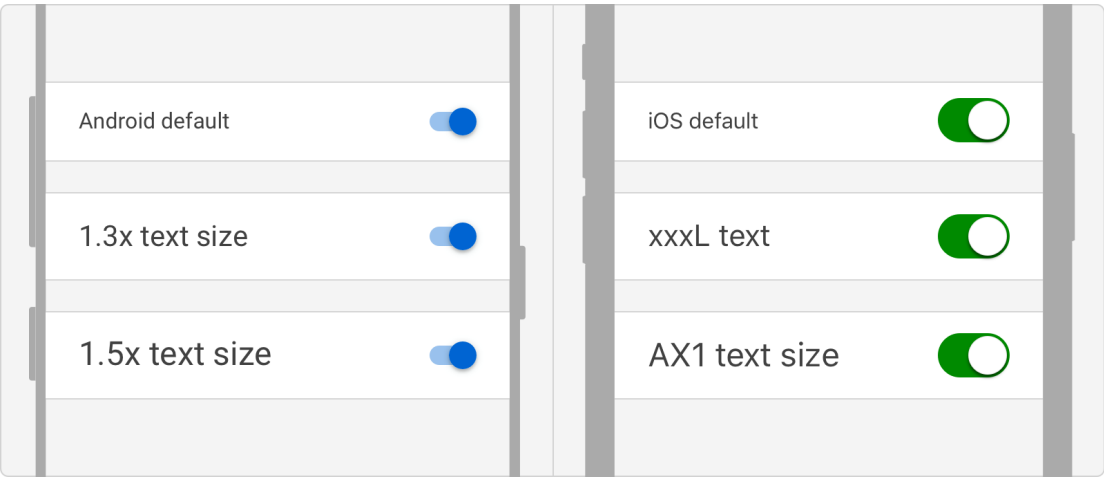
- Tapping or dragging on the switch control **only**.

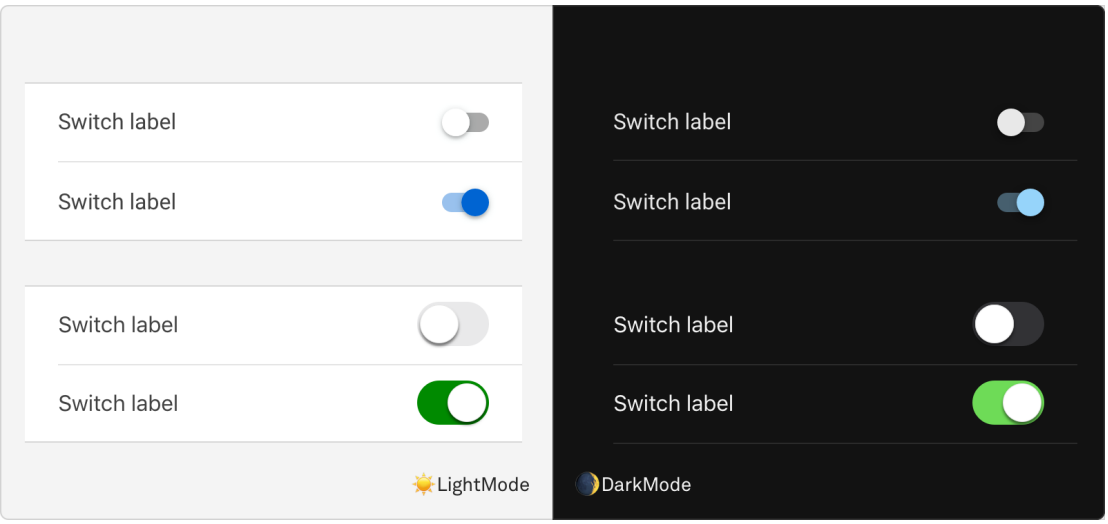
(Note: tapping on the row will not toggle the switch.)

Capabilities

Robust Layout.

Components are scaled automatically based on the user's text size preferences.





Dark Appearances.

Automatically update its appearance based on user's light or dark appearance settings.

Related Patterns

- Single Select Row
- Multi Select Row
- Drill Down Row (*coming soon*)

No labels

Atlassian